

Biodiversity assessment / ecological survey

What this tool produces · *An ecological audit featuring habitat classifications, condition scores, and a calculated baseline of "biodiversity units" required for net-gain compliance.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

G2 · Proof of Fit

Dimensions

Environmental

Spatial

Preparing the workshop · *Biodiversity assessment / ecological survey*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Translating the irreplaceable beauty of a meadow or a stream into a non-negotiable metric, ensuring that the living world holds structural power at the urban planning table.

Evidence we produce

An ecological audit featuring habitat classifications, condition scores, and a calculated baseline of "biodiversity units" required for net-gain compliance.

Duration & Material

Duration · 3 to 6 weeks for field surveys and calculations

Material · Standardized biodiversity metric tools, GIS habitat maps, botanical field guides

Reference case

In England, the Statutory Biodiversity Metric is a legally mandated tool for the town planning system. Before planning permission is granted, developers must calculate the precise baseline value of the natural habitats on their site. By forcing developers to mathematically prove how they will deliver a 10% net gain in biodiversity units, the metric drives the integration of green roofs, restored wetlands, and wildlife corridors into commercial designs.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Habitats × species × pressures × measures

Duration
3 to 6 weeks for field surveys and calculations

Habitats

Natura 2000 · ZNIEFF · local types

Flora & fauna

protected · indicator · invasive

Pressures

fragmentation · pollution · climate

Measures

protect · restore · connect

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.